Appendix D: Historical Overview & Anecdotal Provenance (Part II)

Source: The Estate of Joan "Joannie" Gloeckler (King)

Subject: Relationship with Paul Newman (Circa 1943–1947)

Document Classification: Auxiliary Provenance Record

SECTION I: CHRONOLOGICAL & VERIFIABLE CIVIL EVIDENCE

The following public records and legal documents firmly anchor the relationship timeline to the pre-fame window of Paul Newman’s life, directly corroborating the family's oral history:

- **June 7, 1944 – High School Graduation:** Joan Gloeckler's official diploma confirms her graduation from Shaker Heights High School. This establishes her presence in Shaker Heights, Ohio, just behind Paul Newman (who graduated in January 1943). This chronological alignment perfectly explains why Newman was already serving overseas in the U.S. Navy while Joan was finishing her senior year of high school.
- **1946–1947 – Collegiate Proximity:** Societal press clippings from *The Cleveland Plain Dealer* confirm that Joan attended Denison University in Granville, Ohio, where she **1946–1947 – Collegiate Proximity:** Societal press clippings from *The Cleveland Plain Dealer* confirm that Joan attended Denison University in Granville, Ohio, where she belonged to the Delta Delta Delta sorority and was crowned "Sweetheart of Sigma Chi." Following his Navy discharge in 1946, Paul Newman attended Kenyon College in Gambier, Ohio. The two campuses are located a mere 25 miles apart (roughly a 40-minute drive), providing a verifiable geographic anchor for how their high school romance seamlessly transitioned into their college years.
- **January 3, 1947 – Definitive Timeline Ceiling:** A society page announcement in *The Cleveland Plain Dealer* documents a New Year's Eve cocktail party given by Mr. and Mrs. John P. Gloeckler to announce the engagement of their daughter, Joan Lynn, to Mr. Randall Duane Fulmer. This official public notice places a firm historical boundary on the romantic window with Paul Newman, pinning the gifting of the artifact collection strictly between 1943 and late 1946.

SECTION II: VERIFIED ARTIFACT DESCRIPTION

- **The Inscribed Navy Portrait:** An original 1945 silver gelatin print featuring a young Paul Newman during his World War II service in the Pacific Theater. Newman is pictured in his tropical U.S. Navy white service uniform against a backdrop of palm trees.
  The Handwritten Inscription: This rare, pre-fame artifact features a bold, fountain-pen inscription by Paul Newman in the lower left quadrant. It reads: *“Body and Soul – ‘Bumckus’”*
  Provenance Details: This portrait was gifted by Paul Newman to his high school sweetheart, Joan "Joannie" Gloeckler, while he was deployed overseas. The sign-off "Body and Soul" was Newman’s consistent, romantic signature in his wartime correspondence with Joan. The inclusion of the intimate pet name "Bumckus" serves as a powerful authentication factor. Such a non-public inside joke heavily substantiates the oral history of the relationship, separating it entirely from generic celebrity autographs. The artifact remained preserved in its original silver display frame by the recipient for the remainder of her life.

SECTION III: VERIFIED ANECDOTAL PROVENANCE

The deep value of this archive rests on specific, non-public human details recalled by Joan Gloeckler. These highly unique memories connect directly to obscure, documented facts about Paul Newman's youth and future legacy:

- **The "Newman's Own" Popcorn Genesis:** Decades before Paul Newman launched his global food empire, *Newman’s Own*, where popcorn stood as one of his absolute flagship products, he was an ordinary kid hanging out with the Gloeckler family. The Gloeckler family was notoriously passionate about popcorn, and Joan explicitly noted that her grandmother and family *"taught Paul Newman everything he knows about popcorn."* This unpublicized biographical origin story connects directly to his lifelong food obsession.
- **The "Budin's Deli" Dates & Chaperone:** Joan fondly recalled that their dates frequently took place at a local landmark called "Budin's." Historical archives confirm that Budin's Delicatessen was a prominent 1940s youth hangout located on the corner of Chagrin Boulevard and Avalon Road in Shaker Heights—and crucially, that a teenage Paul Newman worked his first odd job there busing tables for owner Danny Budin. Because Joan was required to bring her younger

brother, John Gloeckler (11 years her junior), along as a chaperone, the young couple would notoriously stash young John "under the stairs" at the delicatessen to secure their privacy.

- **The Popcorn Care Package:** While Newman was deployed to the Pacific Theater as a Navy Aviation Radioman, Joan remained close with his family back in Ohio. She frequently assisted his mother, Mrs. Newman, in the family kitchen packing support care packages consisting of home-baked cakes insulated with popcorn. When Joan expressed worry that the loose popcorn would stick to the frosting, Mrs. Newman laughed and famously corrected her: *"Why Joannie, you put wax paper around the cake!"*
- **The Secret Musician:** Joan was one of the few contemporary witnesses to a private talent of Newman's that remained entirely hidden from the public until decades later. Long before niche Hollywood trivia databases (like IMDb) documented that Paul talent of Newman's that remained entirely hidden from the public until decades later. Long before niche Hollywood trivia databases (like IMDb) documented that Paul Newman was actually a highly skilled, secret jazz and blues piano player, Joan witnessed him frequently playing energetic "Boogie Woogie" piano behind closed doors during their courtship.
- **The College Poster Discovery & Tea Room Reunion:** Decades later, Joan didn't even realize her ex-boyfriend had become a massive global superstar until she saw Paul Newman posters hanging in people's rooms while touring colleges for her daughters. Upon making this discovery, she arranged a date to visit Mrs. Newman's house for tea. During the visit, Mrs. Newman gifted them signed photographs of Paul and wistfully asked, *"Oh Joannie, aren't you sorry?"* to which Joan proudly and happily replied, *"No, no, I'm happily married."*
  The LA Showroom Epilogue: In her professional life, Joan built a prestigious, 40-year career as a board-certified interior designer (ASID). While sourcing materials inside an exclusive, high-end Los Angeles design showroom later in life, she experienced a chance, full-circle encounter with a mature Paul Newman and his wife, Joanne Woodward, beautifully concluding the lifelong narrative arc of their shared history.

- **SECTION IV: APPRAISAL CONTEXT & CONCLUSION**
- The provenance of artifacts associated with legendary actor, director, and philanthropist Paul Newman is largely defined by two major categories: his horological legacy (the "Paul Newman" Rolex Daytonas) and his automotive

racing legacy. Because of his cultural cachet, items with verified ties to his personal life often feature significant "provenance multipliers," with his celebrity status vastly increasing their collectible value. In the high-end memorabilia market, these vivid, ultra-specific human stories are exactly what turn a piece of metal into an invaluable, museum-worthy romance artifact.